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British Consulate for Taiwan,
Takow, 31 May 1874.

No. 10.

My Lord,

In continuation of my despatch No. 9 of the 12th Instant, I have the honour to enclose copies of the undermentioned papers, relating to the Japanese expedition to

The Right Honourable
Lord Tenterden,
&c &c &c
Foreign Office,
London,

Rr Gregory
to
Rr Lowder
11-12 May 1874.
Arrival of Japanese
expedition in Formosa

Enclosure

in Mr Gregory's No. 9

of May 12th 1874

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to Formosa

(1) My despatch to Mr Wade, No. 7 of the 20th inst.

(2) ditto do . 8 . " 27th "

(3) Mr Bullock's Memorandum of a visit to Lang-kiaou or Liang-kiao.

I have the honour to be,
My Lord,
Your Lordship's most obedient,
humble servant
J. Gregory
Chargé officiating

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British Consulate for Taiwan,

Takow, 20 May 1874,

Copy

No 7.

Sir,

I had the honour to receive, this day, your despatch No 1, of the 29th Ultimo, giving instructions concerning the Japanese expedition.

I reported on the subject in Despatch No 6 of the 11th-12th Instant, and have not much to add. The Chinese authorities, though

T. F. Wade Esqre C.B.
H. B. M. Envoy Extraordinary,
&c — &c — &c
Peking.

In Consul
No 10
3 Inclosures

Rec'd 2 Aug 23?
Read

The Japanese expedition in continuation of No 9.

1 Memo
for Dispatch
Circular.

D

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though complaining of the Japanese for acting without communication with them, appear disposed for the present to leave the Japanese alone.

The large Chinese steamer "Yang-woo" has recently arrived again at Anping. The "Fuh-sing" is also there.

H. M. S. "Hornet" which had left Anping for Amoy on the night of the 12th, was off Anping and Takow on the 18th and yesterday, and went south. I did not hear anything from her commanding officer. There is a report that she would stay at Lang-kiaou until relieved.

224

I have not issued any Notification. Hitherto I do not find that British subjects are becoming involved in the matter.

There are some Japanese staying here now. A Captain Kabayama, of the Japanese army, who went lately to Tamsuy by land, has returned hither by the same route.

Your obedient servant,

(Signed) Wm Gregory
Consul Officiating

True Copy
Wm Gregory

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British Consulate for Taiwan,
Takow, 27 May 1874.

Copy

No. 8.

Sir,

In my No 7 of the 20th Instant I said that the Chinese authorities (of Taiwan) seemed disposed for the present to leave the Japanese alone. Perhaps the "Yang-woo" brought them further instructions from Foochow. On the 22nd and 23rd the corvette "Yang-woo" and gunvessel "Tuh-sing" visited Lang-kiaou

T. F. Wade Esqre C.B.
H.B.M. Envoy Extraordinary
&c &c &c
Peking.

Taiwan, 20 May 1874.

The Japanese expedition,

Inclosure No 1.
in Mr Gregory's
No 210.
of 31 May 1874.

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Langkiaow, with several Mandarins. Mr Bullock of this Consulate had a passage in the "Yang-woo", and has written a memorandum, which I enclose and respectfully commend to your notice.

A small Japanese steamer, the "Mo-shun" or "Moa-shan", from Lang-kiaow is now at anchor here at Takow. The Chinese steamers "Fuh-sing" and "Chang-shing" are also here.

It appears that on the 21st a Japanese despatch-vessel arrived at Anping and left speedily, but landed the Japanese Consul of Amoy, who with some other officer visited the Taoutai (at Taiwanfoo) on the 22nd.

The "Hornet" is remaining at Lang-kiaow until relieved. Her commanding officer expects to call here after leaving Langkiaow.

Your obedient servant

(Signed) Wm Gregory

True Copy
Wm Gregory

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True Copy.
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Rec'd May 2...
in despatch
No. 10
of 31 May 1894

Taiwan, 27 May 1894

Re Japanese exhibition
(continued). Mr
Bullock's visit to
Lang-kiao.

Copy

Memorandum of a visit to
Lang-kiao.

I left Takow before
daylight on the morning of
the 22nd May on board the
Chinese Corvette "Yang Wu". There
were also a Captain Farrow of
Amoy, a guest of the Captain,
and Mr Edgar, Commissioner
of Customs here, at whose
request a passage had been
kindly given to me. The
Gunboat

揚武

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gunboat "Fu Hsing" — 〃 福星
accompanied us.

There were three Mandarins on board, the Anping Hsieh-tai, the officer in charge of the Salt duty for the island, and the Erh Fu of Taiwanfu. They informed me that the Japanese Commander had written to the Governor General at Foochow, and that the Governor General had despatched an answer viâ Amoy. They were now sent to enquire if there was any

Answer

answer to the Governor — 〃 General's letter, and to 〃 discuss any points the Japanese wished.

To my surprise, the Mandarins showed me copies of the two letters. I got possession of the copies for a long enough time to make a few notes, but not to write a regular translation of the contents. The first was written by Asi Hsiang, 〃 (probably General "Saigo"), 西鄉
Japanese Chung-Chiang; and 中將
bears the date Ming Chih 7.4.13.

It

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It states that the Formosans so persistently murder people and refuse to obey the Chinese — authorities, that the Emperor of Japan has ordered the writer to penetrate into their country, and inflict such chastisement as will prevent their committing similar crimes again. The expedition has no other object. But the writer, fearing the — Governor General might be misled by false rumours, sends this letter, and prays that the local

local authorities may be — directed to give him every assistance.

The reply states that Formosa is in the maps of China, and has been under Chinese rule for two hundred years. Although the savages are hidden away like wild beasts in the forest, yet they are within the borders and under the rule of China. By — international law everything within the territories of a Country

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country comes under the
government of that country.
The infliction of punishment
is the part of the Chinese.
The Chinese have already
established and garrisoned
forts within the mountains,
and have since saved the
lives of some shipwrecked
Japanese. The conduct of the
Japanese in going to Formosa
without communicating with
the Tsung-li Yamen and
receiving its consent, is against
both

both international law and
the treaty. The Governor General
therefore requests that the soldiers
may be withdrawn, for the sake
of conformity with the treaty
And the preservation of
friendly relations.

On arriving at Lang-kiao
after about four hours passage,
we found H. M. S. "Hornet" —
Anchored in the bay. Her —
officers informed me that
when they arrived on the 19th
there were three hired Japanese
transports at the spot, and
750 men on shore. On the 20th
the

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the Corvette "Haishin" arrived.
She had been surveying on the
opposite coast a few miles
away. On the 22nd, the day
of our arrival, the Gunboat
"Moshun" arrived, and one
hired, and one Government
transport, with 1800 men and
the Imperial Commissioner
and chief of the expedition,
General Saigo, late Apistant
Secretary for War. With the
two Chinese Men of War
there were therefore ten steamers
anchored together in the
bay.

bay. There are about 500
more soldiers expected, making
a total of 3000 men.

There are two Americans
accompanying the expedition,
Messrs Cassell and Watson.
The former, a naval officer
on leave, has received from
the Japanese the rank of
Commodore; the latter that
of Colonel. They do not
appear to have any definite
post, but up to the present
they have, acting through the
Japanese

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Japanese officers, virtually held the command of the expedition. General Legendre was hourly expected, but I heard afterwards that his coming had again been postponed.

Up to the date of our arrival there had been a few skirmishes between the Bautan Savages and stragglers or irregular parties of the Japanese; And one or two lives had been

been lost on both sides. The Japanese soldiers are represented as very little under control. Many of them were formerly officers of higher rank than their present commanders.

Messrs Capell and Wason had gone without an escort into a savage village to the South, to have an interview with the chief, and had come to some peaceable

Arrangement

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arrangement, which included all the villages South of Langkias except one. The men of that village had fired on a reconnoitring party on the shore, and were therefore destined to destruction, after the Bawlans had been dealt with.

The position of the Japanese camp had lately been

been changed on account of the wetness of the ground. It was not fortified in any way. A new camp was also being formed for the latest arrivals, some of whom appeared to be artillerymen, on some dry ground about half a mile to the South.

In the afternoon of the day of our arrival I went for a walk with a small party of Englishmen and the

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the Captain of the "Yang Wu".
We visited a village of Amoy
Chinese near the camp. The
inhabitants were on excellent
terms with the Japanese. They
were delighted at the punishment
of the savages. Several of
them had sums in small
Japanese silver coins, which
they wished to exchange for
Mexican dollars. A man
had been killed that day
by a Japanese who let his
rifle

rifle off unintentionally.
The people acknowledged that
the death was the result of an
accident, and showed no
resentment. The Chinese
Captain was very talkative,
and, whenever he found
Anyone who could understand
Mandarin, informed him
that the Chinese authorities
were going to send the
Japanese away. I noticed a
Japanese proclamation posted
up

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up at the entrance of the village, saying that the object of the expedition was to punish the savages, and that the Japanese felt assured of the friendship of the Chinese inhabitants, and that the latter must not be alarmed. Returning home we saw two Japanese coming in wounded, and four or five parties of soldiers, perhaps one hundred in all, hurrying

hurrying off to the hills.

Next morning we learnt that a somewhat serious engagement had taken place. Fifteen savages had been killed on the spot, and six Japanese. It was reported that there were thirty of the latter wounded; but on visiting the hospital we found only ten men under treatment. The savages to the South, perhaps alarmed at

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at this and wishing to ensure
the maintenance of the —
peaceable arrangements, —
desired to send a present of
cattle and poultry. There
was no intention of fighting
any more for two or three
days, if the men could be
kept back. After that time
the Japanese commanders
hoped to be able to attack
from two or three different
quarters and so surround
the

the Bawtans.

About noon the Chinese
envoys visited the Japanese
Commander-in-chief. The
interview lasted but a very
short time. The envoys told
me afterwards that they had
enquired if the Governor
General's letter had been
received and if there
was any answer to it. The
Japanese General replied that
it was necessary for him to
await the receipt of a letter,
apparently

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apparently a reply, from the Tsung-li Yamen, and that he would then write again to the Governor General. Nothing more passed except a few compliments on both sides.

The Chinese envoys appeared to be in great fear of the Japanese, and were unwilling to go on shore. They also seemed quite helpless and bewildered. I think that, if they had not been

been accidentally thrown in contact with two or three Europeans, no interview would have taken place at all.

The Japanese express themselves very much astonished at the Chinese, who will be much benefited by the expedition, looking upon it with disfavour. They say that their ambassador when at Peking laid great steps on the Chinese Government punishing the savages; to which the Chinese replied that they were

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were unable to do so, and that the Japanese had better undertake the work themselves. This story was on everybody's tongue, and it is in the newspapers as well. But I found it hard to believe, as I remembered the very different tone of the Decree issued two years ago in reply to the Governor General's Memorial on the subject of the

the massacre of the Lewchewans.

I had a conversation with Lieutenant Cassell, who is an old acquaintance of mine. By his earnestness, I might almost say by his vehemence, he quite convinced me that, as far at least as he is aware, there are no designs upon the part of Formosa which is under regular Chinese government. But he left on my mind the

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the impression that the
Japanese mean to regard
the parts of Formosa not
under government as land
open to be taken by anyone;
And that they will try to
keep what they conquer or
occupy, if it seems worth
keeping. I merely gathered
this impression from his
general tone, as he was very
careful not to make use
of a single sentence that I
could

could lay hold of as bearing
any such meaning.

We left for Takow
shortly before daylight
on the 24th.

(signed) T. L. Bullock,
Assistant.

H. M. Consulate, Takow,
25th May 1874.

True Copy
W. Gregory

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Mr. Bullock's
visit to Lang-kiaou.
22-24 May 1874.

Incl. No. 3.
in Mr. Gregory's
Desp. No. 10
of 31 May 1874.